📖 Books & Authors — Indian & International

High-yield Books & Authors for SSC CGL General Awareness. Grouped by category, with the author, the work's claim to fame, **prizes won**, and why each is remembered.

How to use: match book ⇄ author both ways; note Nobel/Booker/Jnanpith winners — they are the most asked.

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🆕 Recently in the News — Book Releases ↑ top

Auto-mined daily from GKToday (headlines only; click to read). Today's are highlighted.

Headline	Date
No book headlines captured yet — run after GKToday posts book news.	

IN Indian Authors — Classic & Modern ↑ top

Author	Famous Works	Prize / Importance
Rabindranath Tagore	Gitanjali, Gora, The Home and the World, Ghare-Baire	Nobel Prize in Literature 1913 (first non-European); wrote India's & Bangladesh's national anthems
R.K. Narayan	Malgudi Days, The Guide, Swami and Friends, The Man-Eater of Malgudi	Sahitya Akademi Award; created fictional town "Malgudi"
Mulk Raj Anand	Untouchable, Coolie, Two Leaves and a Bud	Pioneer of Indian English novel; social realism
Munshi Premchand	Godan, Gaban, Nirmala, Idgah	"Upanyas Samrat" (Emperor of Novels); Hindi-Urdu fiction
Kalidasa	Abhijnanasakuntalam, Meghaduta, Raghuvamsha, Kumarasambhava	Classical Sanskrit poet-dramatist; gem of Chandragupta II's court
Chanakya (Kautilya)	Arthashastra	Ancient treatise on statecraft, economics & military strategy
Bankim Chandra Chatterjee	Anandamath (source of "Vande Mataram"), Durgeshnandini	Wrote India's national song

Author	Famous Works	Prize / Importance
Sarat Chandra Chattopadhyay	Devdas, Parineeta, Srikanta	Most popular Bengali novelist
Vikram Seth	A Suitable Boy, The Golden Gate	Sahitya Akademi Award; one of the longest English novels
Amitav Ghosh	The Shadow Lines, The Hungry Tide, Ibis trilogy (Sea of Poppies)	Jnanpith Award 2018 (first English-language writer to win it)

IN Indian Writing in English — Booker & Global Honours ↑ top

Author	Famous Work(s)	Prize won
Arundhati Roy	The God of Small Things	Booker Prize 1997
Kiran Desai	The Inheritance of Loss	Booker Prize 2006 (youngest woman then)
Aravind Adiga	The White Tiger	Booker Prize 2008
Salman Rushdie	Midnight's Children, The Satanic Verses, Shame	Booker 1981; "Booker of Bookers"
V.S. Naipaul	A House for Mr Biswas, A Bend in the River	Nobel 2001; Booker 1971 (Indian-origin, Trinidad)
Geetanjali Shree	Tomb of Sand (Ret Samadhi)	International Booker 2022 (first Hindi work)
Jhumpa Lahiri	Interpreter of Maladies, The Namesake	Pulitzer Prize 2000
Chetan Bhagat	Five Point Someone, 2 States, Half Girlfriend	Best-selling popular English fiction in India
Ruskin Bond	The Blue Umbrella, The Room on the Roof, Rusty stories	Sahitya Akademi & Padma Bhushan; beloved children's author

🏆 Jnanpith Award Winners (high-yield) ↑ top

Writer	Language	Note
Ashapurna Devi	Bengali	First woman to win the Jnanpith (1976)
G. Sankara Kurup	Malayalam	First-ever Jnanpith awardee (1965)
Mahasweta Devi	Bengali	Hajar Churashir Maa; activist-writer
Amitav Ghosh	English	First English writer to win (2018)
Gulzar (Sampooran Singh)	Urdu	2023 (announced 2024); poet-lyricist
Kuvempu	Kannada	Sri Ramayana Darshanam
Mahadevi Verma	Hindi	"Modern Meera"; Chhayavaad poet

🏅 Nobel Prize in Literature — Notable Winners ↑ top

Author	Country	Year & known for
Rabindranath Tagore	India	1913 — Gitanjali (first Asian Nobel laureate)
Ernest Hemingway	USA	1954 — The Old Man and the Sea
Gabriel García Márquez	Colombia	1982 — One Hundred Years of Solitude (magic realism)
Bob Dylan	USA	2016 — first musician to win Literature Nobel
Kazuo Ishiguro	UK (Japan-born)	2017 — The Remains of the Day, Never Let Me Go

Author	Country	Year & known for
Abdulrazak Gurnah	Tanzania/UK	2021 — Paradise; colonialism & refugees
Annie Ernaux	France	2022 — autobiographical writing
Han Kang	South Korea	2024 — The Vegetarian (also Int'l Booker 2016)

 Freedom Fighters & Their Works ↑ top

Freedom Fighter	Books / Works	Note
Mahatma Gandhi	The Story of My Experiments with Truth (autobiography), Hind Swaraj, Key to Health; edited *Young India* & *Harijan*	Wrote mostly in Gujarati; "experiments with truth"
Jawaharlal Nehru	The Discovery of India, An Autobiography (Toward Freedom), Glimpses of World History, Letters from a Father to His Daughter	Most written in prison
Bal Gangadhar Tilak	Gita Rahasya, The Arctic Home in the Vedas, Orion; newspapers *Kesari* & *Maratha*	"Swaraj is my birthright"
Lala Lajpat Rai	Unhappy India, The Story of My Deportation, Young India, England's Debt to India	"Punjab Kesari"
Bipin Chandra Pal	The Soul of India, The New Spirit, Nationality and Empire	Part of "Lal-Bal-Pal"
Subhas Chandra Bose	The Indian Struggle, An Indian Pilgrim (autobiography)	Founded INA; "Give me blood..."
Maulana Abul Kalam Azad	India Wins Freedom, Ghubar-e-Khatir; edited *Al-Hilal*	First Education Minister; Education Day on his birthday

Freedom Fighter	Books / Works	Note
Sarojini Naidu	The Golden Threshold, The Bird of Time, The Broken Wing	"Nightingale of India"
Bhagat Singh	Why I Am an Atheist (essay), Jail Notebook	Revolutionary martyr
Dadabhai Naoroji	Poverty and Un-British Rule in India	"Grand Old Man of India"; Drain Theory
Rajendra Prasad	India Divided, Atmakatha (autobiography)	First President of India
Sri Aurobindo	The Life Divine, Savitri, Essays on the Gita	Revolutionary turned philosopher-yogi
Swami Vivekananda	Raja Yoga, Karma Yoga, Jnana Yoga, Bhakti Yoga	Chicago 1893 address
M.N. Roy	India in Transition, Reason, Romanticism and Revolution	Founder of Indian communism

🏛 Recent Politician / Leader Books in India — & who released them ↑ top

Book	Author	Year	Released by / Note
The Emergency Diaries	(on PM Modi's life, 1975–77 Emergency)	2025	Released by **Amit Shah** (Jun 2025), marking 50 yrs of the Emergency
Apnapan: Narendra Modi Sang Mere Anubhav	Shivraj Singh Chouhan	2024	His political experiences with PM Modi
Exam Warriors	Narendra Modi	2018	Penguin/BlueKraft; tips for students (updated ed. 2022)
Atal Bihari Vajpayee – The Eternal Statesman	Vijay Goel	2024	Vajpayee's birth-centenary year tribute

Book	Author	Year	Released by / Note
The Sage who Reimagined Hinduism	Dr. Shashi Tharoor	2024	On Sree Narayana Guru & social equality
Why I Am a Hindu	Shashi Tharoor	2018	Also "The Battle of Belonging" (2020), "An Era of Darkness" (2016)
Chalice of Ambrosia: Ram Janmabhoomi	Surendra Kumar Pachauri	2024	Ram Janmabhoomi movement
Listening, Learning & Leading	M. Venkaiah Naidu	2024	Ex-Vice-President's memoir
Heart Lamp	Banu Mushtaq (trans. Deepa Bhasthi)	2025	International Booker 2025 (Kannada stories)
Indira Gandhi: A Life in Nature	Jairam Ramesh	2017	On Indira's environmental legacy
One Life Is Not Enough	K. Natwar Singh	2014	Ex-External Affairs Minister's memoir
India's Moment / many works	Shashi Tharoor	2023	One of Parliament's most prolific authors

🗞️ Current-Affairs Books — Recently in the News ↑ top

Merged from the repo's Current-Affairs book notes (source: GKNow). Verify dates before exam use.

Book	Author	Theme / Released by
Agatthiyar – The Unifier	Kalaimagal Magazine	Sage Agatthiyar; North–South cultural unity
India's First Olympic Gold	K. Arumugam	India's 1928 Amsterdam hockey gold; **released by P.T. Usha**

Book	Author	Theme / Released by
Apnapan: Narendra Modi Sang Mere Anubhav	Shivraj Singh Chouhan	Political experiences with PM Modi
Atal Bihari Vajpayee – The Eternal Statesman	Vijay Goel	Vajpayee's legacy
The Sage who Reimagined Hinduism	Dr. Shashi Tharoor	Sree Narayana Guru & social equality
Chalice of Ambrosia: Ram Janmabhoomi	Surendra Kumar Pachauri	Ram Janmabhoomi movement
The Emergency Diaries	(on PM Modi)	PM Modi during the 1975–77 Emergency; **released by Amit Shah**

Quick MCQ recall: *The Sage who Reimagined Hinduism* → Shashi Tharoor · *India's First Olympic Gold* → hockey (K. Arumugam) · *Apnapan* → Shivraj Singh Chouhan.

🌍 International Authors & Classics ↑ top

Author	Famous Works	Note
William Shakespeare	Hamlet, Macbeth, Othello, Romeo & Juliet, King Lear	"Bard of Avon"; greatest English playwright
Leo Tolstoy	War and Peace, Anna Karenina	Russian literary giant
Charles Dickens	Oliver Twist, Great Expectations, A Tale of Two Cities	Victorian social novelist
Jane Austen	Pride and Prejudice, Emma, Sense and Sensibility	Classic English romance & satire
George Orwell	1984, Animal Farm	Political dystopia & satire
J.K. Rowling	Harry Potter series	Best-selling book series in history
Chinua Achebe	Things Fall Apart	"Father of African literature"

Author	Famous Works	Note
Paulo Coelho	The Alchemist	One of the most translated living authors
Khaled Hosseini	The Kite Runner, A Thousand Splendid Suns	Afghan-American best-seller
Fyodor Dostoevsky	Crime and Punishment, The Brothers Karamazov, The Idiot	Russian psychological novelist
Mark Twain	The Adventures of Tom Sawyer, Huckleberry Finn	"Father of American literature"
Homer	The Iliad, The Odyssey	Ancient Greek epics
Dante Alighieri	The Divine Comedy	Italian medieval masterpiece
Victor Hugo	Les Misérables, The Hunchback of Notre-Dame	French Romantic giant
Ernest Hemingway	The Old Man and the Sea, A Farewell to Arms, For Whom the Bell Tolls	Nobel 1954

 Autobiographies & Memoirs ↑ top

Book	Author / Subject	Note
The Story of My Experiments with Truth	Mahatma Gandhi	Gandhi's autobiography (in Gujarati)
Wings of Fire	A.P.J. Abdul Kalam (with Arun Tiwari)	Missile Man's life
An Autobiography (Toward Freedom)	Jawaharlal Nehru	Written in prison
The Long Walk to Freedom	Nelson Mandela	Anti-apartheid struggle
My Experiments / The Diary of a Young Girl	Anne Frank	WWII Holocaust diary
Playing It My Way	Sachin Tendulkar	Cricketer's memoir
I Am Malala	Malala Yousafzai	Nobel Peace laureate's story

Book	Author / Subject	Note
Becoming	Michelle Obama	Best-selling memoir

📘 Classic Books by Leaders / Statesmen ↑ top

Book	Author	Note
The Discovery of India	Jawaharlal Nehru	Basis of the TV series "Bharat Ek Khoj"
India Wins Freedom	Maulana Abul Kalam Azad	Partition-era memoir
Hind Swaraj	Mahatma Gandhi	On self-rule
Indomitable Spirit / Ignited Minds	A.P.J. Abdul Kalam	Vision for India
Exam Warriors	Narendra Modi	For students facing exams
The Test of My Life	Yuvraj Singh	Battling cancer

🔥 International Best-sellers & Popular Reads ↑ top

Book	Author	Why popular
Harry Potter (series)	J.K. Rowling	Best-selling book series in history
The Alchemist	Paulo Coelho	Among the most-translated books ever
The Kite Runner	Khaled Hosseini	Global best-seller on Afghanistan
To Kill a Mockingbird	Harper Lee	Pulitzer 1961; racism & justice
The Da Vinci Code	Dan Brown	Blockbuster thriller
The Lord of the Rings	J.R.R. Tolkien	Defining fantasy epic
The Great Gatsby	F. Scott Fitzgerald	American classic (Jazz Age)

Book	Author	Why popular
Pride and Prejudice	Jane Austen	Most-loved English romance
Sapiens: A Brief History of Humankind	Yuval Noah Harari	Best-selling non-fiction; also "Homo Deus"
The Diary of a Young Girl	Anne Frank	Most-read WWII account
Rich Dad Poor Dad	Robert Kiyosaki	Best-selling personal finance
Wings of Fire	A.P.J. Abdul Kalam	India's best-loved inspirational memoir

 Landmark Science Books ↑ top

Book	Author	Significance
On the Origin of Species	Charles Darwin	Theory of evolution by natural selection (1859)
Philosophiæ Naturalis Principia Mathematica	Isaac Newton	Laws of motion & universal gravitation
A Brief History of Time	Stephen Hawking	Cosmology for the public; also "The Universe in a Nutshell"
The Selfish Gene	Richard Dawkins	Gene-centred view of evolution
Cosmos	Carl Sagan	Famous popular-astronomy book/series
Relativity: The Special & General Theory	Albert Einstein	Einstein's own explanation
The Double Helix	James Watson	Discovery of DNA's structure
Silent Spring	Rachel Carson	Launched the environmental movement
A Short History of Nearly Everything	Bill Bryson	Popular survey of science
Dialogue Concerning the Two Chief World Systems	Galileo Galilei	Defended the heliocentric model

🧪 Indian Scientists' Books & Popular Science ↑ top

Book	Author	Note
Wings of Fire	A.P.J. Abdul Kalam (with Arun Tiwari)	Autobiography of the "Missile Man"
Ignited Minds / India 2020	A.P.J. Abdul Kalam	Vision for a developed India
The Test of Time / Turning Points	A.P.J. Abdul Kalam	Reflections from his Presidency
What is Life? (Indian editions) / popular essays	J.B.S. Haldane	Worked in India (ISI Kolkata)
The Man Who Knew Infinity (about him)	on Srinivasa Ramanujan	Mathematical genius; book by Robert Kanigel
My Inventions / scientific papers	Jagadish Chandra Bose	Plant response & radio waves pioneer
The Grand Design (read widely in India)	Hawking & Mlodinow	Popular among Indian aspirants

⚛ Nobel Science Laureates — India-linked & Key ↑ top

Scientist	Field & Year	Known for
C.V. Raman	Physics 1930	Raman Effect (scattering of light); first Indian science Nobel
Har Gobind Khorana	Medicine 1968	Genetic code & protein synthesis (India-born)
Subrahmanyan Chandrasekhar	Physics 1983	Chandrasekhar limit (white dwarfs); Raman's nephew
Venkatraman Ramakrishnan	Chemistry 2009	Structure of the ribosome (India-born)
Albert Einstein	Physics 1921	Photoelectric effect (not relativity!)

Scientist	Field & Year	Known for
Marie Curie	Physics 1903, Chemistry 1911	Radioactivity; only person with Nobels in two sciences
Alexander Fleming	Medicine 1945	Discovery of Penicillin
James Watson & Francis Crick	Medicine 1962	DNA double-helix structure

🎖️ Major Literary Prizes — at a glance ↑ top

Prize	Scope	Key facts
Nobel Prize in Literature	International	Since 1901; awarded in Stockholm, Sweden. Tagore = first Asian (1913).
Booker Prize	English-language fiction (UK)	Indians: Naipaul, Rushdie, Roy, K. Desai, Adiga
International Booker	Translated fiction	Geetanjali Shree (Tomb of Sand, 2022) — first Hindi/Indian win
Jnanpith Award	India's highest literary award	Languages in the 8th Schedule + English; since 1965
Sahitya Akademi Award	India — 24 languages	Given by the National Academy of Letters
Pulitzer Prize	USA — journalism & letters	Jhumpa Lahiri won for fiction (2000)
Vyas Samman / Saraswati Samman	India (K.K. Birla Foundation)	For Hindi / Indian-language literary works

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Exam tip: SSC most often asks *book ⇄ author* matching and "*who won which prize*". Memorise the Booker-winning Indians, Tagore's 1913 Nobel, and the Jnanpith "firsts". For current-affairs books, see 13_Books_and_Authors.md.